Dr. Valentin Kiefner

Postdoctoral Researcher
Vienna University of Economics and Business

Personal Information

Institute for International Business
Department of Global Business & Trade
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Birth date: 07 March 1994
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Academic Positions

09/2020–Current **WU Vienna University of Economics & Business**
Position: Research & Teaching Associate
Department: Department of Global Business & Trade
Supervisor: Univ.-Prof.Dr. Alexander Mohr

09/2019–08/2020 **WU Vienna University of Economics & Business**
Position: Academic Tutor
Department: Department of Global Business & Trade

International Appointments

08/2022–12/2022 **Keio University**
Position: Visiting PhD Researcher
Faculty: Faculty of Business and Commerce
Location: Tokyo, Japan
Funding: International Research Fellow Program, WU Vienna
Supervisor: Dr. Chie Iguchi

Education

09/2020–03/2026 **Doctorate Economic & Social Sciences (with honors)**
WU University of Economics & Business, Vienna, Austria
Thesis: "Corporate Sustainability Action in International Business: Success Factors for Strategic Implementation and Challenges for Operational Realization"
Advisor: Univ.-Prof.Dr. Alexander Mohr
Co-Advisor: Univ.-Prof.Dr. Jonas Puck
Co-Advisor: Prof. Hafiz Mirza

02/2022–06/2024 **Micro Master Statistics & Data Science (MITx)**
MIT's Institute for Data, Systems, and Society (IDSS), online on eDx

09/2018–08/2020 **MSc Export & Internationalization Management (with honors)**
WU University of Economics & Business, Vienna, Austria
Thesis: "Small Firms - Big Cases: SMEs in the Context of International Investment Disputes"
Advisor: Mag.Dr. Simon Hartmann

03/2013–03/2017 **BA Corporate Management & Economics**
Zeppelin University, Friedrichshafen, Germany
Thesis: "Establishing Linkages Between Leadership and Emotional Intelligence – The Case of the Narcissistic Leader"
Advisor: Prof.Dr. Carmen Tanner

Publications

Journal Publications

2022 **Kiefner, V.**, Mohr, A., & Schumacher, C. (2022). Female executives and multinationals' support of the UN's Sustainable Development Goals. *Journal of World Business*, Vol.57(3), DOI: 10.1016/j.jwb.2021.101304
(4 Journal – AJG 2024) | Citations: ∼50 | Media Coverage: 10+ outlets

Conference Proceedings

2023 Tihanyi, C., Mohr, A., Schumacher, C., & **Kiefner, V.** (2023). When Does it Pay to Have a Chief Digital Officer? *Best Papers Proceedings / Academy of Management*, DOI: 10.5465/AMPROC.2023.12432

Manuscripts in Revision

2026 **Kiefner, V.**, Konara, P., Mohr, A., & Shirodkar, V. (2024). Diversifying for Resilience: How Supply Base International Diversification Relates to Supply Base Sustainability Performance.
Outlet: *Journal of International Business Studies* (4* Journal – AJG 2024)
Status: R&R Round 3, initiated 06-Mar-2026

2026 **Kiefner, V.**, Mohr, A., & Tihanyi, C. (2024). International Diversification and Multinationals' Support of the UN's Sustainable Development Goals: The moderating Role of Digital Technologies.
Outlet: *International Business Review* (3 Journal – AJG 2024)
Status: R&R Round 3, initiated 03-Mar-2026

2025 Konara, P., Mohr, A., & **Kiefner, V.**. (2023). The contingent effect of supply base complexity on firm performance: The moderating role of the Covid-19 pandemic.
Outlet: *Journal of Operations Management* (4* Journal – AJG 2024)
Status: R&R Round 1, initiated 03-Mar-2025 (additional data collection in-process)

Working Papers

In Preparation **Kiefner, V.**, Stahl, G., & Schumacher, C. (2026). When Backlash Meets Corporate Climate Action: Societal Polarization and the Relationship Between Top Management Team Diversity and Emissions Reduction in Multinationals.
Outlet: *Strategic Management Journal*

Invited Academic Conferences

2025 **AIB USNE 2025 Conference**: Global Business in a Time of Geopolitical Uncertainty. Bryant University, Rhode Island, USA. *Academy of International Business US Northeast Chapter*

2024 **50th EIBA Anniversary Conference 2024**: JIBS Paper Development Workshop. Aalto University, Helsinki, Finland. *European International Business Academy*

2024 **AIB Annual Conference**: The Dynamics of International Business. Kyung Hee University, Seoul, South Korea. *Academy of International Business*

2023 **EURAM Annual Conference**: Transforming Business for Good. Trinity College, Dublin, Ireland. *European Academy of Management*

2022 **38th EAMSA Annual Conference**: Achieving the Sustainable Development Goals: Prospects and Implications for Euro-Asia Business. Keio University, Tokyo, Japan. *Euro-Asia Management Studies Association*

2022 **11th EIASM Workshop on TMTs**: Strategic Leadership for Sustainability and Social and Political Responsibility. École des Hautes Études Commerciales (HEC), Paris, France. *European Institute for Advanced Studies in Management*

2021 **47th EIBA Annual Conference 2021**: Firms, Innovation and Location: Reshaping International Business for Sustainable Development in the Post-Pandemic Era. Universidad Complutense, Madrid, Spain. *European International Business Academy*

Awards, Research Grants, and Scholarships

finalist Palgrave McMillan EAMSA Best Paper Award (2022)

EUR 1000 Top-Publication Premium (2022), WU Vienna, Austria

EUR 2300 International Research Fellow Program (2022), WU Vienna, Austria

EUR 8000 Small Project Funding for Junior Researchers (2021/2022), B&C Private Foundation, Bank Austria

EUR 1000 Merit-based Scholarship Grant (2020), WU Vienna, Austria

Teaching Experience

Course Type	Total Courses	Distinct Courses	Total Enrollments	Total ECTS
Graduate-Level	6	14	∼880	42
Undergraduate-Level	3	3	∼90	68
International Programs	3	6	∼210	15
Total	**12**	**23**	**∼1180**	**125**

Table 1: Teaching experience overview by course type

Graduate-Level Courses

1. **Research Design** (Summer 2026). MSc Export & Internationalization Management, WU Vienna, Austria. Co-instructor. ∼30 students. 5 ECTS. Programme course.

2. **Models of Internationalization** (Winter 2021–2024). MSc Export & Internationalization Management, WU Vienna, Austria. Co-instructor. ∼120 students. 5 ECTS. Programme course.

3. **Master Thesis Coaching** (Summer 2021–2024). MSc Export & Internationalization Management, WU Vienna, Austria. Thesis coach/Co-instructor. ∼20 students. 2 ECTS. Programme course.

4. **Export Management** (Winter 2022/2023). MSc Export & Internationalization Management, WU Vienna, Austria. Co-instructor. ∼120 students. 7.5 ECTS. Programme course.

5. **SME Management** (Winter 2021/2022). MSc Export & Internationalization Management, WU Vienna, Austria. Co-instructor. ∼120 students. 7.5 ECTS. Programme course.

6. **Research Design / Literature Seminar** (Summer 2021/2022). MSc Export & Internationalization Management, WU Vienna, Austria. Co-instructor. ∼30 students. 5 ECTS. Programme course.

Undergraduate-Level Courses

1. **International Business Applications** (Summer 2025). BSc International Business, WU Vienna, Austria. Course leader. ∼30 students. 5 ECTS. Specialization course.

2. **Global Strategy and International Alliances** (Summer 2025). BSc International Business, WU Vienna, Austria. Co-instructor. ∼30 students. 5 ECTS. Specialization course.

3. **International Business Strategy** (Summer 2025). International programmes (international students), WU Vienna, Austria. Co-instructor. ∼30 students. 5 ECTS. Course offering for international students.

International Programs & Summer Schools

1. **International Summer University: Strategy Meets Finance** (Summer 2025). WU Vienna, Austria. Co-instructor. ∼30 students. 5 ECTS. Two-week intensive programme for incoming international students (co-taught with PD Dr. Jakob Müllner).

2. **Bangkok Summer School on International Business & Sustainable Development** (Summer 2022–2025). Mahidol University – CMMU (Thailand). Co-developer & instructor. ∼40 students. 8 ECTS. Three-week intensive programme on global value chains, corporate sustainability, and UNSDGs.

3. **Erasmus+ International Short Program** (Summer 2023). University of Sarajevo, Bosnia and Herzegovina. Instructor/Co-developer. ∼20 students. 2 ECTS.Intensive programme on Entrepreneurship and Sustainable Development in International Business (funded by European Commission).

Thesis Supervision

Master Level Theses (Co-supervisor)

1. **Emanuel Frank** (2024, completed). Sustainability Implementation in Logistics Companies: The Influencing Role of the Insurance Sector. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC17088491

2. **Maximilian Müller-Guttenbrunn** (2023, completed). Measures to Increase Electronic Waste Collection Rates: An Integrative Literature Review. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC17010455

3. **Marcel Krainz** (2023, completed). Does Sustainability Increase Firm Performance? A Panel Data Analysis During the COVID-19 Pandemic. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC17083758

4. **Luca Anton Christandl** (2023, completed). Circular Economy: Development of a Holistic Model for Circular Transition in the Manufacturing Industry. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC17026452

5. **Theresa Hirsch** (2023, completed). Success Factors for Cybersecurity Adoption in Austrian SMEs: Assessing the Threat Landscape and Developing a Framework Applicable for SMEs. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC17022329

6. **Belinda Beimrohr** (2023, completed). Empowering Environmental Sustainability in the Austrian Hotel Industry: Identifying Drivers for Sustainable Energy Measures. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC17025457

7. **Mariam Rashwan** (2023, completed). Pathways to Achieving the UN Sustainable Development Goals: The Role of Multinational Enterprises in Austria and Digitalization Measures for SDG Implementation. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC16984544

8. **Philipp Wersch** (2022, completed). Challenges When Monitoring Sub-suppliers with Regards to Environmental Sustainability. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC16698539

9. **Bettina Stöllinger** (2022, completed). Benefits of Being Part of the Solution: Sustainable Development Goals as a Promoter of Dynamic Green Capabilities. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC16706131

10. **Bernhard Wieseneder** (2022, completed). Corporate Sustainability Disclosure of Austrian Listed Companies: A Systematic Content Analysis. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC16693373

11. **Charlott Sophie Mahler** (2022, completed). Global Cities: Location Choice and Performance Outcomes. Is There a Zone of Optimal Performance for Foreign Subsidiaries in Vienna? WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC16713128

12. **Stella Henriette Pohlner** (2022, completed). Sustainability in Automotive First-tier Supply Chains: How Can Automotive Focal Firms Implement Their Sustainability Standards into Their First-tier Supplier Relationships? WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC16734910

13. **Doris Vindl** (2022, completed). Institutional Factors and Environmental Disclosure: An Emerging Market Perspective. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC16678927

14. **Angelo Eder** (2021, completed). The Influence of Digitalization on SME Firm Performance During the COVID-19 Pandemic: A Qualitative Case Study. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC16664543

15. **Rico Schöffmann** (2021, completed). Implementation of Codes of Conduct Guidelines Across Global Supply Chains: A Literature Review on Sustainable Supply Chain Management in International Business Research. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC16421544

16. **Melanie Sochatzy** (2021, completed). Sustainable Supply Chain Management in Multinational Enterprises and the Effect of Stakeholder Pressure: A Cross-Industry Multiple Case Study. WU Vienna, Austria. https://permalink.obvsg.at/wuw/AC16404566

Bachelor Level Theses (Co-supervisor)

1. **Julia Leitner** (2021, completed). A Systematic Literature Review on the Global Dimension of Corporate Sustainability in International Business (IB) Research. WU Vienna, Austria.

Schools and Workshops Attended

Feb 2026	Artificial Intelligence and Large Language Models for Social Scientist. *WU Vienna University*, AT
Jan 2026	Reproducible Research with Python. *WU Vienna University*, AT
Mar 2022	Applied Quantitative Methods. *Copenhagen Business School*, DK
Nov 2020	Theory of the MNE & Economics of IB. *Henley Business School, University of Reading*, UK

Community Services

Department Conference

1. *Elected Junior Faculty Representative* (2026): Department of Global Business & Trade
2. *Elected Junior Faculty Representative* (2025): Department of Global Business & Trade

Languages

German (native), English (fluent), French (Baccalauréat général level), Latin (Great Latinum)

Personal Interests

Triathlon (Ironman finisher 2024/2025), trail running (ultramarathon), friends and good discussions, mountaineering and snowboarding (often Alps), passionate cook, interested in classical music, literature, and cinema.

References

Prof. Dr. Günter K. Stahl (Mentor)

Position:	Professor at Vienna University of Economics & Business
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Prof. Dr. Jonas Puck (Ph.D. Co-Advisor)

Position:	Professor at Vienna University of Economics & Business
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Christian Schumacher PhD (Co-Author, Mentor)

Position:	Assistant Professor (Tenure Track) at Vienna University of Economics & Business
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Vienna - Austria, March 23, 2026